Competition and Farmer Choice in Agricultural Equipment

Public comment on agricultural equipment manufacturing and distribution

Docket FTC-2026-1585 | Document FTC-2026-1585-0002

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Chico, California | 29 October 2026

PUBLIC COMMENT - suitable for the public docket

Give farmers a real choice

A farmer should be able to keep a Deere tractor and choose somebody else's weed-control equipment, software and service. That choice matters when a new approach can make an expensive operation substantially cheaper. Competition in agricultural equipment reaches beyond the sale of a tractor: it includes who gets to supply the tools, technology and support used with it.

I am Christopher Laudando, founder of Laudando & Associates LLC (L&A), which develops L&Aser, a modular laser-weeding technology. I ask the Federal Trade Commission and the U.S. Department of Agriculture to examine the practices that determine whether independent technologies can reach farmers: access to evaluation, integration, capital, distribution and continuing support. Our experience pursuing those opportunities is the reason for this submission.

The inquiry asks how equipment-market practices affect entry, innovation and farmer welfare. [1] This public comment sets out the competitive questions. The appendix places our chronology alongside OEM financial trends. The separate nonpublic submission supplies a fuller account and selected supporting records for the agencies to investigate.

The customer can stay while the spending moves

Deere's See & Spray offering requires a renewable software license for in-crop application passes. Case IH advertises SenseApply with lifetime Live VRA use and a one-time activation fee for Selective Spray, without annual or per-acre fees. The products have different capabilities, including SenseApply's green-on-brown and Base + Boost modes, but their fee structures show that equipment makers can compete on how farmers pay for technology. [2-3]

AGCO describes a strategy of retrofit, factory-fit and OEM offerings that work across mixed fleets. [4] A challenger therefore does not have to replace a farmer's entire equipment ecosystem to win business. It can compete by improving one operation on the machines already in the field.

If a laser system reliably replaces substantial herbicide applications at a lower total cost, it could compete for the premium paid for spraying equipment, recurring software fees and related service revenue. The farmer could remain a Deere tractor customer while moving that spending elsewhere. How much of Deere's technology-growth premium depends on keeping that spending attached to its platform?

That creates different incentives. An incumbent weighs a new product's revenue against the revenue it may displace. A challenger weighs similar cannibalization against the chance to win customers and acres from competitors. The financial divergence in the appendix makes those incentives worth examining. The records of actual commercial decisions can show how they played out.

The route to market begins before a sale

An independent manufacturer needs access to growers, field evaluation, integration partners and financing before it can offer farmers a proven commercial alternative. A restriction at any of those stages can prevent the comparison from happening. The questions are practical: Who controls access? What conditions must an entrant accept? Are the requirements applied consistently? Can an independent supplier meet them?

We have built and deployed equipment. In 2026, we deployed the Row Ready L&Aser implement at Busch Organics in Bairnsdale, Victoria, and at Peninsula Fresh Organics in Victoria. I also attended and spoke at AgTech Alchemy on May 19, 2025. Those activities are part of our effort to put the technology in front of farmers, partners and the industry.

Our route to market also included a hybrid dual-licensing strategy. The perception code released on GitHub in May 2025 was part of Dual Licensing V1.0. That release did not fully open-source L&Aser. The distinction matters when examining how an independent developer tries to broaden access while retaining a commercial path for its technology.

Grower qualification, insurance requirements, demonstration access, technical interfaces and permission to publish results all deserve scrutiny. So do financing conditions, exclusivity provisions and investment conflicts. For each disputed decision, the agencies should obtain the terms, the reason given at the time, the people involved and communications with interested third parties.

Safety review should be grounded in measurements. Farmers need clear information about optical hazards, crop injury, weed control, field capacity and operating limits. The agencies should examine the tests behind safety statements and how those statements were communicated to prospective customers and evaluation partners.

Questions for the agencies

Question 3 - Restrictions on sales and service: My experience spans the United States and Australia. Examine the restrictions affecting access to competing equipment and support, their contractual or legal basis, their geographic reach, and their effect on growers and integrators.

Question 8 - Communications and coordination: Obtain the communications and decision records concerning access to growers, evaluations, financing and distribution. Map relevant ownership and investment interests. Compare the treatment of competing suppliers and the explanations given for accepting, conditioning or refusing an opportunity.

Question 9 - Access tied to a particular seller: Examine what happens to software activation, diagnostics, parts, warranty and support when equipment is resold or combined with another supplier's products. What fees, compatibility rules or support restrictions follow the equipment, and how do they affect the owner's choice?

Question 10 - U.S. and foreign terms: Compare the same equipment and functionality across countries, including price, financing, software, warranty, service, resale and customer eligibility. Our cross-border experience identifies specific issues and participants for follow-up.

Questions 11-13 - Retaliation: My account is from the perspective of an independent manufacturer and public critic. Examine whether criticism, use of an independent channel or support for a competing technology was followed by worse commercial treatment. Identify who made the decision and what explains it. Farmers, integrators, suppliers and employees need a practical confidential route to provide their records.

The other dealer-network questions can be answered through contracts, policies, transaction records and interviews with the affected dealers and customers. Those records should be assessed alongside the broader pathway by which new equipment reaches a farm.

Litigation and commercial access

Carbon Autonomous Robotic Systems Inc. filed its Eastern District of California patent action against L&A on October 31, 2024. The preliminary-injunction order was filed June 13, 2025 and included an adverse likelihood-of-infringement determination. A permanent-injunction order was signed October 13, 2026 and filed October 14, with a separate default judgment entered October 14. [5]

These orders belong in the record alongside the commercial history. The agencies should examine the equipment-support decisions, commercial conditions, evaluation access and communications to prospective customers described in the submission, including how those decisions affected the availability of competing technology.

Measure what the farmer actually pays

The useful comparison is total cost per acre for a specified agronomic result over a season. Include equipment and financing, recurring fees, labor, energy, consumables, treatment speed, repeat passes, weed stage and density, crop injury, downtime, remaining herbicide needs, support and resale value. That is the comparison a farmer needs to decide whether a different system is worth adopting.

The effect of lost market access can arrive before many machines are sold. An entrant needs field results, service capacity and workable commercial terms to compete. Examine whether restrictions prevented those steps, and what that meant for farmers' ability to evaluate another option.

Compare results across representative farms, including operating limits and unsuccessful trials. Keep demonstrations, expressions of interest, completed purchases and measured field results distinct so the agencies can see what each record contributes.

What I am asking the agencies to do

Obtain the equipment, software, support, resale and integration terms, together with the records explaining how they are applied. Examine whether incompatibility or selective access restrictions keep farmers from choosing complementary products and services.

Investigate the specific accounts of denied or conditioned evaluation, distribution and financing opportunities through the participants and contemporaneous communications. Compare the treatment of competing suppliers and follow the evidence about who made the decisions and why.

Assess whether vendor qualification and safety-review requirements are proportionate to the actual work and risk, and whether independent suppliers have a workable way to satisfy them. Support independent comparisons of agronomic results and total operating cost.

The question running through this submission is simple: can a farmer obtain reliable weed control more cheaply from another supplier while keeping the equipment that already works? Farmers should have a fair opportunity to find out.

References

[1] FTC and USDA Request for Public Comments on Agricultural Equipment Sector

Docket FTC-2026-1585. Scope, questions and submission instructions, pages 2-4. Accessed 29 October 2026.

https://www.ftc.gov/system/files/ftc_gov/pdf/RFI-AgEquipment.pdf

[2] John Deere Sprayers and Applicators

Current U.S. product-page footnote concerning renewable software licensing for See & Spray in-crop passes. Accessed 29 October 2026.

https://www.deere.com/en-us/products-solutions/sprayers-and-applicators

[3] Case IH SenseApply Offers Affordable Versatile Sense and Act Application Technology

CNH/Case IH release, 2 March 2025; lifetime Live VRA, Selective Spray activation and operating modes. Accessed 29 October 2026.

https://media.cnh.com/north-america/case-ih/case-ih-senseapply-offers-affordable--versatile-sense-and-act-application-technology/s/bd9165a2-63ea-4807-a921-3f218a076119

[4] AGCO Precision Agriculture

Company description of retrofit, factory-fit, OEM and mixed-fleet offerings. Accessed 29 October 2026.

https://www.agcocorp.com/us/en/home/precision-agriculture.html

[5] Carbon Autonomous Robotic Systems Inc v Laudando and Associates LLC

U.S. District Court, Eastern District of California, No. 2:24-cv-03012. Docket 74, preliminary injunction, filed 13 June 2025; docket 105, order signed 13 October and filed 14 October 2026; docket 106, judgment entered 14 October 2026. Court-record citations refer to the records reviewed through 28 October 2026.

Appendix A

OEM market context and L&Aser chronology

Public redacted edition | Record and market-data cutoff: 28 October 2026

The economic question and the sequence of events

A farmer can stay with Deere while moving weed-control spending to another supplier. The financial panels show the context in which equipment makers evaluate that prospect: different earnings expectations, shareholder returns and valuations. The chronology places company announcements alongside L&A's demonstrations, deployments, licensing decisions and commercial history.

John May identified 2026 as the expected cycle bottom in February and reaffirmed that forecast in August (#97 and #119). Those statements belong alongside the opportunities and obstacles facing an independent technology. The underlying communications and decisions are what I ask the agencies to investigate.

How the public and nonpublic counts reconcile

The public chronology contains 166 entries: 73 disclosed and 93 with descriptions redacted. The separately prepared nonpublic submission contains 158 entries: the same 73 disclosed entries plus 85 of the 93 redacted entries. Eight redacted entries remain excluded from that submission pending separate legal or privilege review. It is therefore not a fully unredacted counterpart of the public chart.

Public chart	166 entries = 73 disclosed + 93 redacted
Prepared nonpublic register	158 entries = 73 disclosed + 85 additional
Held separately	8 of the 93 redacted entries

L&A made the public-release redactions. The 93 count refers to entries, not individual black bars or alleged violations. The separate submission requests confidential treatment for designated portions. The selected exhibit volume includes the records identified in its index.

Why the numbers are not sequential

The register is ordered by date. The numbers are permanent reference IDs: later additions keep their assigned numbers so links between the chart, source register and exhibits remain intact. Every event ID from #1 through #166 is present; no entries have been removed.

Reading the appendix

The timeline groups use the same date axis. The register preserves the visible black-line redactions. Sources for the corrected public events follow the register. The financial panels retain their original values and methodology.

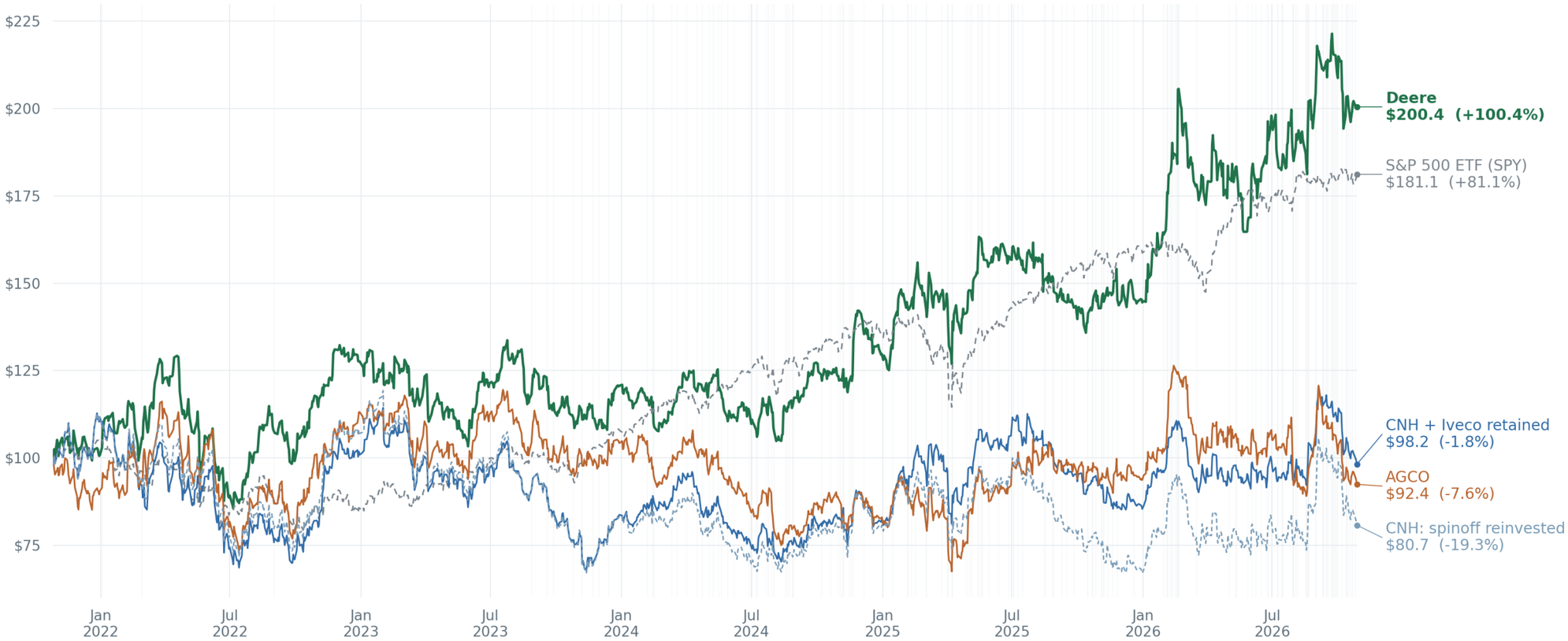
Date key: * marks provisional screenshot-based dates for #105 and #111. The double dagger at #123 marks a reported/document date. The preprint (#131) was published on September 29, 2026; GitHub and Zenodo metadata confirm that date.

Total shareholder return

Original financial panel | Data through 28 October 2026 | Economic context

A TOTAL SHAREHOLDER RETURN

Value of $100 invested on 26 Oct 2021 • Gross USD • Dividends reinvested



Value of $100 invested on 26 October 2021, through 28 October 2026; dividends reinvested. Gross USD returns exclude taxes and transaction costs. CNH is shown with the Iveco spinoff retained and with proceeds reinvested. Iveco uses local closing prices and the provider's dated EUR/USD series; these are not simultaneous global closing marks.

Market-price source: Yahoo Finance daily prices and corporate actions; AGCO closing-price cross-check: AGCO investor relations. FY2027 estimates: FMP via Bigdata.com, dated 27 October 2026. Historical lower panels retain the provisional quarterly method described in the chart.

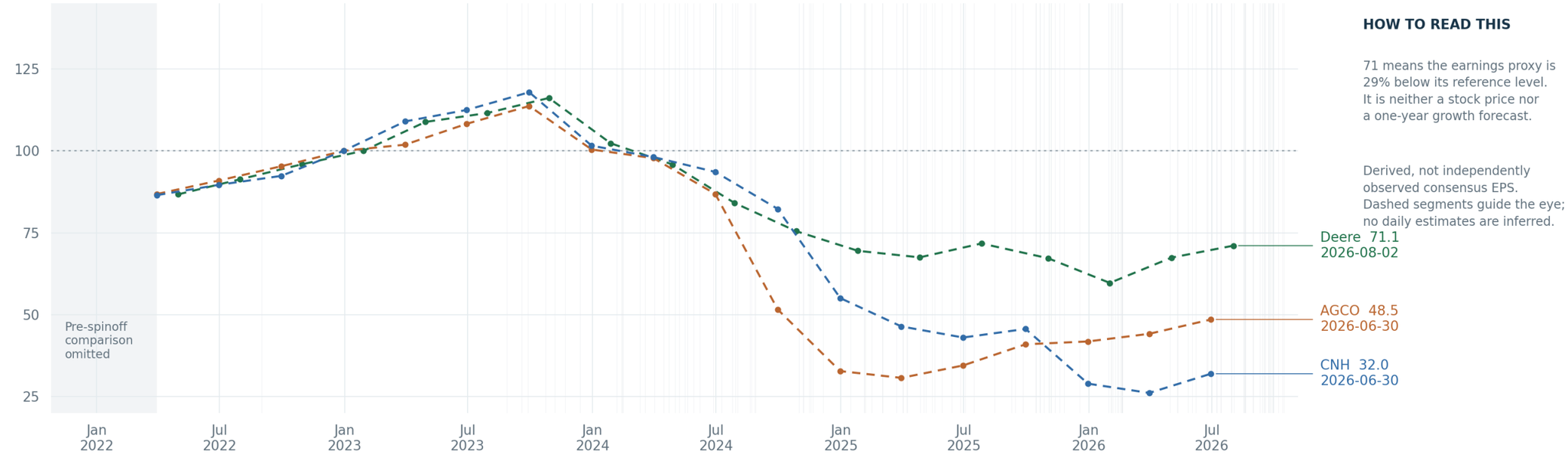
Implied forward earnings - quarterly proxy

Original financial panel | Data through 28 October 2026 | Economic context

B IMPLIED FORWARD EARNINGS

Quarterly proxy: raw closing price ÷ published forward P/E • Reference = 100

Reference: latest fiscal-end snapshot at 31 Jan 2023 (DE: 29 Jan; AGCO / CNH: 31 Dec). Dots retain their actual fiscal-end dates.



HOW TO READ THIS

71 means the earnings proxy is 29% below its reference level. It is neither a stock price nor a one-year growth forecast.

Derived, not independently observed consensus EPS. Dashed segments guide the eye; no daily estimates are inferred.

This is a price/forward-P/E implied-earnings proxy, indexed to the stated reference observation. It is not reported operating income or independently observed historical consensus EPS. Fiscal-end dates differ; dashed lines guide the eye between quarterly observations and do not establish daily earnings estimates.

Market-price source: Yahoo Finance daily prices and corporate actions; AGCO closing-price cross-check: AGCO investor relations. FY2027 estimates: FMP via Bigdata.com, dated 27 October 2026. Historical lower panels retain the provisional quarterly method described in the chart.

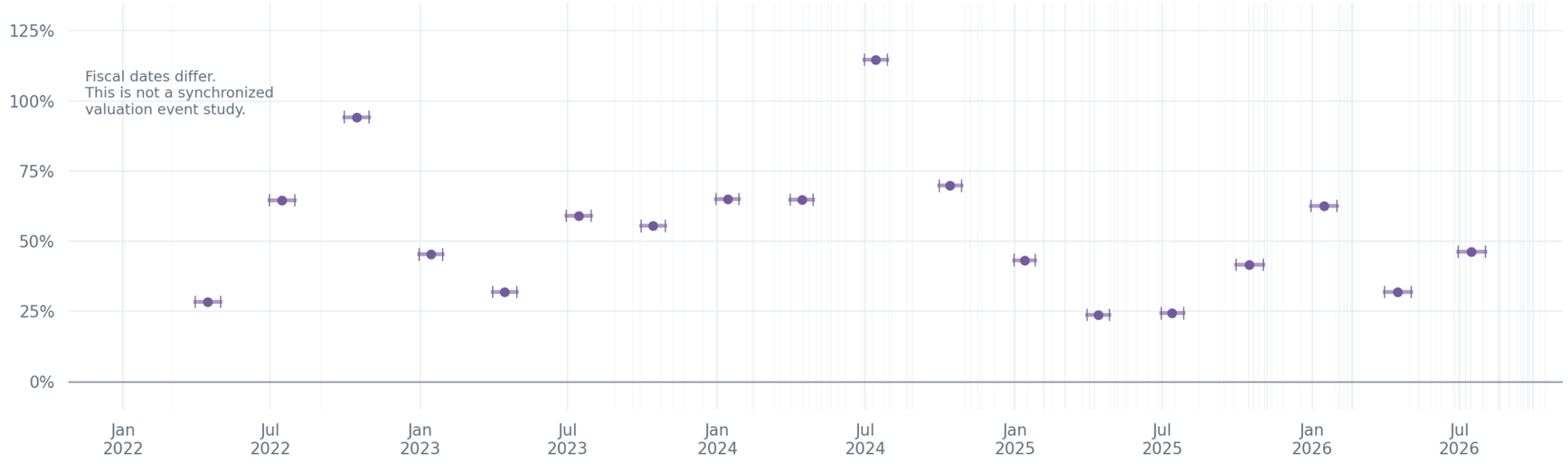
Deere valuation-premium proxy and separate FY2027 snapshot

Original financial panel | Data through 28 October 2026 | Economic context

C DEERE VALUATION-PREMIUM PROXY

100 × [DE forward P/E ÷ average(AGCO forward P/E, CNH forward P/E) − 1]

Paired quarterly observations only. Horizontal bars span the two fiscal dates (26–33 days apart); they are not confidence intervals.



SEPARATE FY2027 SNAPSHOT

87.9% premium

28 Oct close / 27 Oct estimates

	FY27 P/E	EPS growth[1]
DE	28.2×	25.4%
AGCO	13.9×	30.8%
CNH	16.1×	53.1%

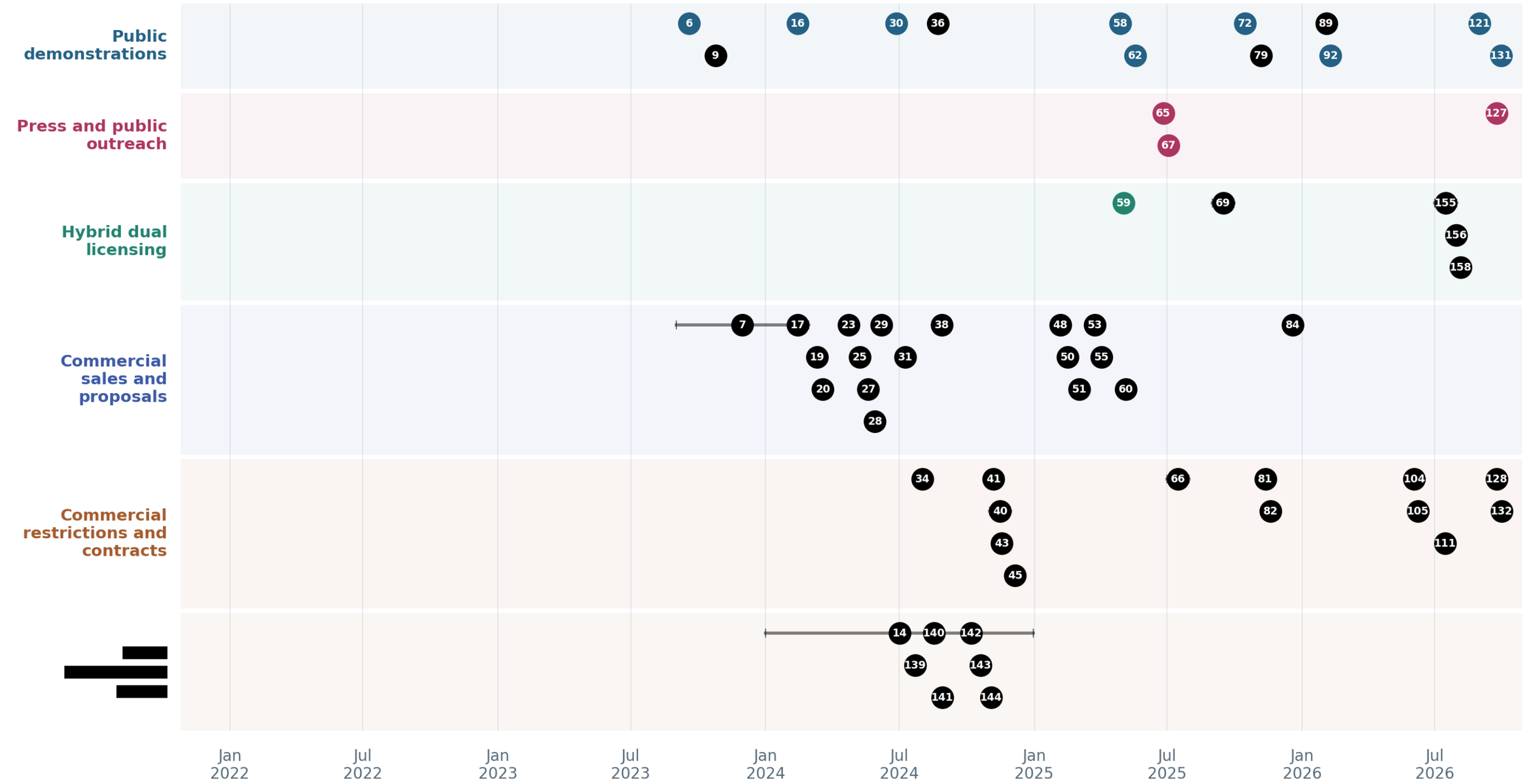
[1] FY2027 vs FY2026 consensus. Different fiscal year ends. This FY2027 estimate basis is not joined to the historical proxy.

Historical observations compare Deere's published forward P/E with the arithmetic average of AGCO and CNH. Horizontal spans identify the two fiscal dates, not confidence intervals. The separate FY2027 snapshot uses 28 October closing prices and 27 October EPS estimates; it is not joined to the historical series. The 87.9% figure is a relative P/E premium, not an overvaluation or damages estimate.

Market-price source: Yahoo Finance daily prices and corporate actions; AGCO closing-price cross-check: AGCO investor relations. FY2027 estimates: FMP via Bigdata.com, dated 27 October 2026. Historical lower panels retain the provisional quarterly method described in the chart.

Aligned event timelines | Part 1 of 3

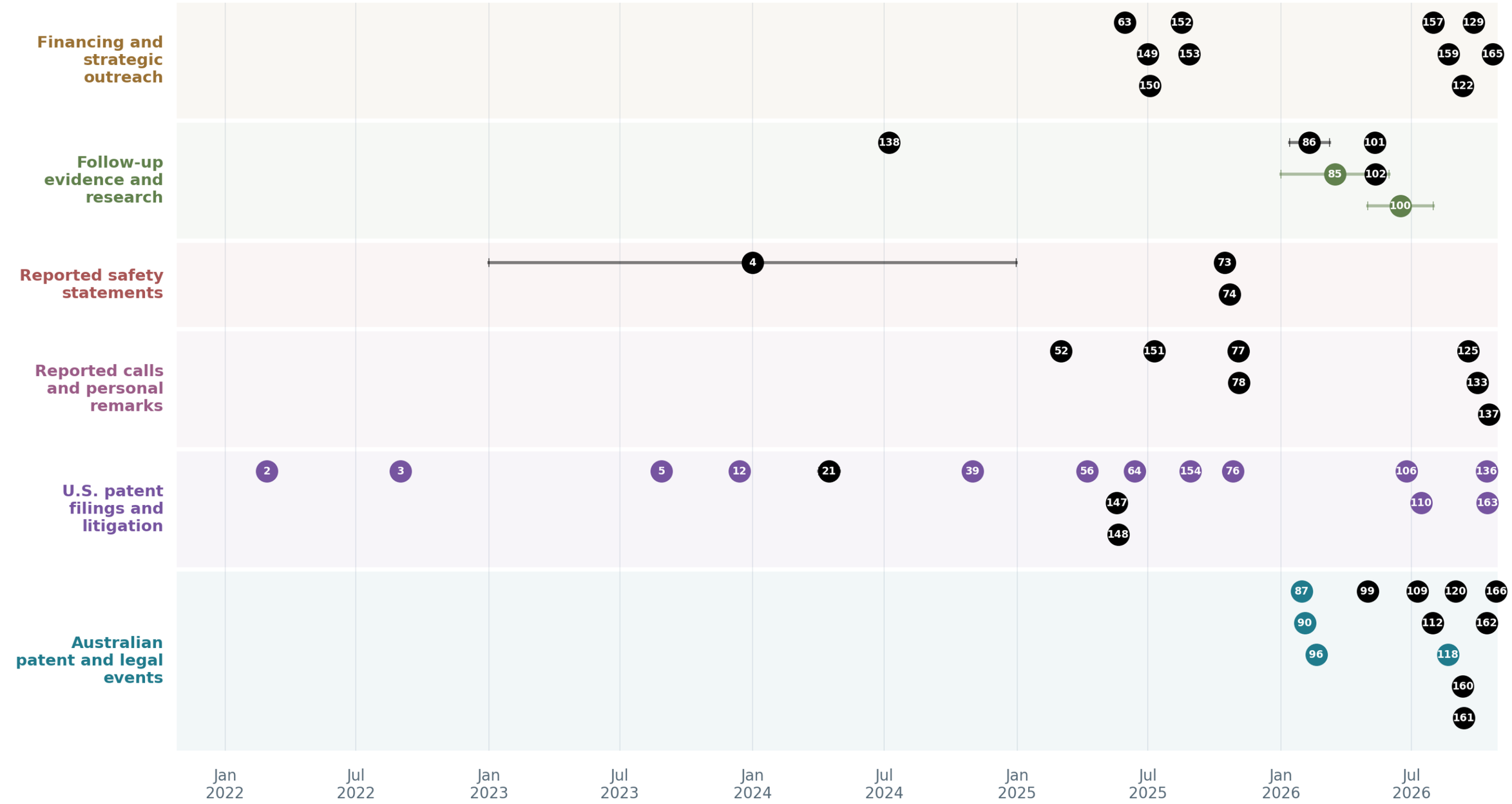
Same date scale on every timeline page. Black markers identify redacted entries; colored markers identify disclosed entries. Horizontal lines indicate date ranges. Original event IDs link to the register.



Dates identify the event, document, report or stated deadline described in the register. Ranges identify a period of work or activity. Event IDs are permanent cross-references; the register is arranged by date.

Aligned event timelines | Part 2 of 3

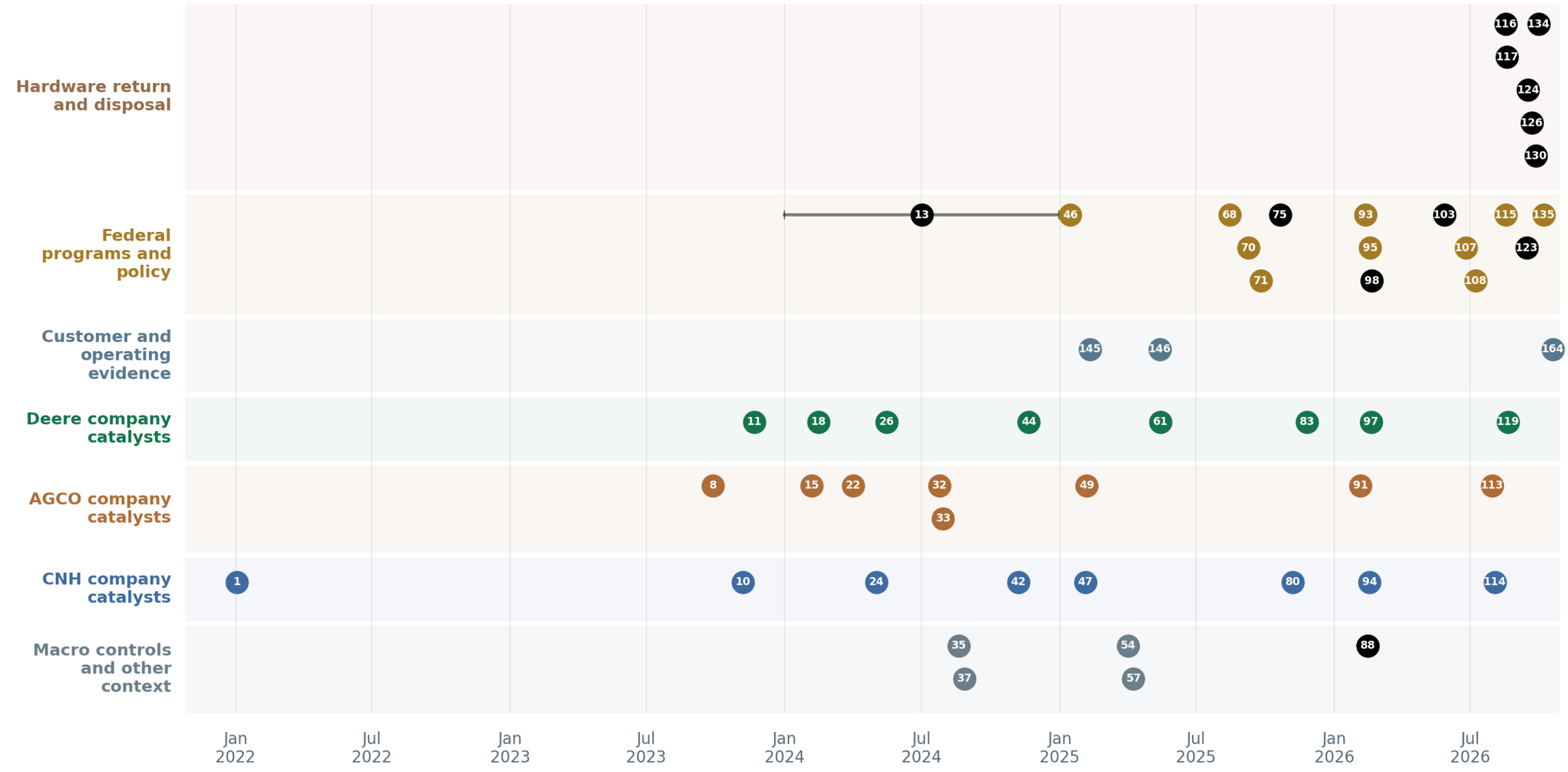
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Aligned event timelines | Part 3 of 3

Same date scale on every timeline page. Black markers identify redacted entries; colored markers identify disclosed entries. Horizontal lines indicate date ranges. Original event IDs link to the register.



Dates identify the event, document, report or stated deadline described in the register. Ranges identify a period of work or activity. Event IDs are permanent cross-references; the register is arranged by date.

Public event register

166 entries | 73 disclosed | 93 redacted

Arranged by date. Numbers are permanent reference IDs, not sequence numbers; later additions keep their IDs so chart and exhibit references remain consistent.

Date key: * marks provisional screenshot-based dates for #105 and #111. The double dagger at #123 marks a reported/document date. The preprint (#131) was published on September 29, 2026; GitHub and Zenodo metadata confirm that date.

1 **3 Jan 2022 Iveco starts separate trading**
Demerger effective January 1; Iveco trading begins January 3.

2 **28 Feb 2022 International patent filing**
L&A files international application PCT/US2022/070878.

3 **1 Sep 2022 International patent publication**
WO2022183222A1 published; disclosure enters the public record.

4 **2023–2024** [redacted]

5 **28 Aug 2023 U.S. patent application filed**
Continuation-in-part application 18/457,151 filed.

7 **SEP 2023–FEB 2024** [redacted]

6 **19 Sep 2023 FIRA USA public debut**
L&A announces the L&Aser debut; publication followed on September 26.

8 **28 Sep 2023 AGCO–Trimble deal announced**
AGCO announces an agreement for an 85% interest in an agricultural-technology joint venture.

9 **24–26 OCT 2023** [redacted]

10 **7 Nov 2023 CNH restructuring announced**
CNH reports softer markets and announces a restructuring program.

11 **22 Nov 2023 Deere initial FY2024 outlook**
Net-income guidance at announcement: $7.75–8.25 billion.

12 **14 Dec 2023 U.S. application published**
U.S. patent application US20230397597A1 is published.

13 **2024** [redacted]

14 **2024** [redacted]

15 **6 Feb 2024 AGCO initial 2024 outlook**
Guidance at announcement: EPS about $13.15 and sales about $13.6 billion.

16 **13–15 FEB 2024 L&Aser Beta at World Ag Expo**
L&A unveils the L&Aser Beta module at World Ag Expo.

17 **13–15 FEB 2024** [redacted]

18 **15 Feb 2024 Deere lowers FY2024 outlook**
Net-income guidance reduced to $7.50–7.75 billion.

19 **11 Mar 2024** [redacted]

20 **19 Mar 2024** [redacted]

22 **1 Apr 2024 PTx Trimble transaction closes**
The announced precision-ag transaction closes; AGCO owns 85% of the joint venture.

21 **APR 2024** [redacted]

23 **23 Apr 2024** [redacted]

24 **2 May 2024 CNH lowers 2024 outlook**
CNH reduces sales and margin forecasts amid weaker agricultural demand.

25 **8 May 2024** [redacted]

26 **16 May 2024 Deere lowers outlook again**
FY2024 net-income guidance reduced to approximately $7.0 billion.

27 **20 MAY 2024** [redacted]

28 **29 May 2024** [redacted]

29 **7 Jun 2024** [redacted]

30 **27 Jun 2024 Salinas public field day**
The UC Cooperative Extension field-day program includes L&Aser and Carbon Robotics.

138 **8 Jul 2024** [redacted]

31 **9 Jul 2024** [redacted]

139 **23 Jul 2024** [redacted]

32 **25 Jul 2024 AGCO divestiture agreement**
AGCO announces an agreement to sell its Grain & Protein business for approximately $700 million.

33 **30 Jul 2024 AGCO lowers 2024 outlook**
Full-year sales and earnings guidance reduced.

34 **2 Aug 2024** [redacted]

140 **7–28 AUG 2024** [redacted]

35 **20 Aug 2024 Ecorobotix executive appointment**
Ecorobotix announces Cameron Holbrook as North America CEO.

36 **22–24 AUG 2024** [redacted]

37 **27 Aug 2024 Ecorobotix appointment coverage**
The Packer covers Cameron Holbrook's appointment as Ecorobotix North America CEO.

38 **28 Aug 2024** [redacted]

141 **29 Aug 2024** [redacted]

142 **7 Oct 2024** [redacted]

143 **15–25 OCT 2024** [redacted]

39 **31 Oct 2024 U.S. patent action filed**
Carbon files its patent action against L&A in the Eastern District of California, case 2:24-cv-03012.

40 **NOV 2024** [redacted]

144 **2–4 NOV 2024** [redacted]

41 **6–7 NOV 2024** [redacted]

42 **7 Nov 2024 CNH cuts 2024 guidance**
CNH cites weak end markets and elevated dealer inventories.

43 **18 NOV 2024** [redacted]

44 **21 Nov 2024 Deere initial FY2025 outlook**
Net-income guidance: $5.0–5.5 billion, compared with $7.1 billion in FY2024.

45 **6 Dec 2024** [redacted]

46 **15 Jan 2025 FTC and states sue Deere**
The FTC and states file an antitrust lawsuit over Deere's restrictions on equipment repair.

47 **4 Feb 2025 CNH initial 2025 outlook**
Adjusted EPS guidance of $0.65–0.75, with emphasis on reducing inventories.

48 **5–6 FEB 2025** [redacted]

49 **6 Feb 2025 AGCO reaffirms 2025 outlook**
EPS guidance $4.00–4.50 and sales target approximately $9.6 billion.

145 **10 Feb 2025 Carbon G2 product launch**
Carbon Robotics launches the G2 LaserWeeder.

50 **15–16 FEB 2025** [redacted]

52 **3 MAR 2025** [redacted]

51 **3–4 MAR 2025** [redacted]

53 **24–25 MAR 2025** [redacted]

54 **2 Apr 2025 Reciprocal tariffs announced**
Broad import duties announced under Executive Order 14257; implementation was staggered.

55 **3 Apr 2025** [redacted]

56 **8 Apr 2025 Preliminary injunction requested**
Carbon asks the court for a preliminary injunction against L&A.

57 **9 Apr 2025 Partial tariff pause announced**
A 90-day pause on country-specific rates announced, excluding China.

58 **28 Apr 2025 L&A technical presentation**
L&A presents its prescription and throughput framework at UC Davis.

59 **3 May 2025 Hybrid Dual Licensing V1.0 released**
L&A releases perception code on GitHub under Dual Licensing V1.0. Alpha Module perception came years earlier; this was not a full open-source release of L&Aser.

60 **6 May 2025** [redacted]

146 **14 May 2025 Public G1 auction closes**
The auction displays a $389,000 bid, subject to seller confirmation.

61 **15 May 2025 Deere updates FY2025 outlook**
Net-income range becomes $4.75–5.50 billion, including tariff assumptions then in effect.

62 **19 May 2025 Laudando speaks at AgTech Alchemy**
Christopher Laudando attends and delivers a speech at AgTech Alchemy at the Gates Foundation Discovery Center in Seattle.

147 **19 May 2025** [redacted]

148 **21 May 2025** [redacted]

63 **30 May 2025** [redacted]

64 **13 Jun 2025 U.S. preliminary injunction filed**
Docket 74 filed June 13; order signed June 12.

65 **26 Jun 2025 AgFunderNews coverage**
AgFunderNews covers the U.S. injunction and L&A's dual-licensing response.

149 **1 Jul 2025** [redacted]

66 **JUL 2025** [redacted]

67 **3 Jul 2025 The Packer coverage**
Coverage describes dual licensing and a proposed Australian relocation.

150 **4 Jul 2025** [redacted]

151 **10 Jul 2025** [redacted]

68 **15 Aug 2025 Draft MAHA strategy reported**
News coverage describes a leaked draft of the MAHA strategy.

152 **15–18 AUG 2025** [redacted]

153 **27–28 AUG 2025** [redacted]

154 **29 Aug 2025 Earlier default motion denied**
The court denies Carbon's earlier default-judgment motion without prejudice.

69 **SEP 2025** [redacted]

70 **9 Sep 2025 Final MAHA strategy released**
The final strategy includes precision application and reduced pesticide use.

71 **26 Sep 2025 DOJ-USDA antitrust MOU**
Memorandum signed September 26; publicly announced September 29.

72 **15–16 OCT 2025 Gatton public showcase**
L&A unveils L&Aser in Australia at the Gatton AgTech Showcase.

73 **15–16 OCT 2025** [redacted]

75 **21 Oct 2025** [redacted]

74 **21–23 OCT 2025** [redacted]

76 **27 Oct 2025 Default judgment requested**
Carbon files its motion for default judgment against L&A.

77 **3 NOV 2025** [redacted]

78 **4 NOV 2025** [redacted]

79 **6 Nov 2025** [redacted]

80 **7 Nov 2025 CNH cuts 2025 outlook**
Adjusted EPS guidance reduced to $0.44–0.50 amid tariff pressure.

81 **12 Nov 2025** [redacted]

82 **19 Nov 2025** [redacted]

83 **26 Nov 2025 Deere initial FY2026 outlook**
Net-income guidance $4.00–4.75 billion; management anticipates an agricultural trough.

84 **19 Dec 2025** [redacted]

85 **JAN–MAY 2026 Busch Organics deployment**
L&A deploys the Row Ready L&Aser implement at Busch Organics in Bairnsdale, Victoria.

86 **13 JAN–9 MAR 2026** [redacted]

87 **30 Jan 2026 Australian patent claims amended**
Carbon's amended Australian claims specify damaging or killing plants.

88 **FEB 2026** [redacted]

89 **3 Feb 2026** [redacted]

90 **3 Feb 2026 Australian application accepted**
Acceptance recorded February 3; acceptance notice dated February 9.

91 **5 Feb 2026 AGCO initial 2026 outlook**
EPS guidance $5.50–6.00 and sales $10.4–10.7 billion.

92 **9 Feb 2026 L&A platform filing announcement**
L&A announces a patent filing covering photonic phenotyping and trait development.

93 **12 Feb 2026 RFK Jr. and Theo Von discuss affordable laser weeding**
The podcast features Carbon Robotics' LaserWeeder. RFK Jr. says making laser weeding affordable for smaller farmers would make it an answer.

94 **17 Feb 2026 CNH initial 2026 outlook**
CNH projects global industry retail demand down approximately 5%.

95 **18 Feb 2026 Glyphosate supply executive order**
Order invokes Defense Production Act authority for phosphorus and glyphosate supply.

96 **19 Feb 2026 Accepted AU specification published**
AU2025200151 B2 accepted specification published.

97 **19 Feb 2026 John May calls 2026 the cycle bottom**
May points to recovery in construction and small agriculture as grounds for expecting 2026 to be the cycle bottom. Deere raises net-income guidance to $4.5-5.0 billion.

98 **20 FEB 2026** [redacted]

99 **1 May 2026** [redacted]

100 **MAY–JUL 2026 Peninsula Fresh Organics deployment**
L&A deploys the Row Ready L&Aser implement at Peninsula Fresh Organics in Victoria, including broccoli field work.

101 **11 MAY 2026** [redacted]

102 **12 MAY 2026** [redacted]

103 **27–28 MAY 2026** [redacted]

104 **2–4 JUN 2026** [redacted]

105 **8 JUN 2026*** [redacted]

106 **24 Jun 2026 Default relief recommended**
The magistrate judge recommends default judgment and a permanent injunction against L&A.

107 **25 Jun 2026 Supreme Court: Monsanto v. Durnell**
The Court holds that federal pesticide-labeling law preempts Durnell's state-law cancer-warning claim against Monsanto, reversing and remanding the case.

155 **JUL 2026** [redacted]

108 **8 Jul 2026 Deere repair settlement announced**
FTC and states announce settlement and proposed order, subject to court approval at announcement.

109 **9 Jul 2026** [redacted]

110 **14 Jul 2026 L&A U.S. patent issued**
U.S. Patent 12,677,822 B2 is issued to L&A.

111 **15 JUL 2026*** [redacted]

112 **30 Jul 2026** [redacted]

113 **30 Jul 2026 AGCO narrows 2026 outlook**
EPS guidance $5.50–5.75 and sales $10.1–10.2 billion.

156 **30 Jul 2026** [redacted]

157 **31 Jul 2026** [redacted]

114 **3 Aug 2026 CNH narrows guidance higher**
FY2026 guidance moves to the upper end of prior ranges.

158 **5 Aug 2026** [redacted]

115 **17 Aug 2026 ARPA-H launches STREAM**
The federal research program includes laser ablation and miniature autonomous weeders among its precision and nonchemical weed-control technologies.

116 **17 Aug 2026** [redacted]

117 **19 Aug 2026** [redacted]

118 **20 Aug 2026 Australian patent action filed**
Carbon files its Australian patent action against L&A, Federal Court case VID946/2026.

119 **20 Aug 2026 Deere reaffirms cycle-bottom forecast**
John May reaffirms that 2026 should mark the ag-equipment cycle bottom, citing orders, used-equipment inventories and technology adoption. Profit guidance rises to $4.75-5.00 billion.

159 **21 Aug 2026** [redacted]

120 **31 Aug 2026** [redacted]

121 **31 Aug 2026 L&A delayed-competition analysis**
L&A publishes a model of adoption delays and their potential cost to farmers.

122 **10 Sep 2026** [redacted]

160 **10 Sep 2026** [redacted]

161 **11 Sep 2026** [redacted]

123 **14 SEP 2026‡** [redacted]

124 **16 Sep 2026** [redacted]

125 **17 SEP 2026** [redacted]

126 **18–24 SEP 2026** [redacted]

127 **23 Sep 2026 Australian dispute press coverage**
Good Fruit & Vegetables covers the patent dispute and its effect on growers' access to L&Aser.

128 **23 Sep 2026** [redacted]

129 **24–25 SEP 2026** [redacted]

130 **26 Sep 2026** [redacted]

131 **29 SEP 2026 Photon Agronomy preprint published**
L&A publishes Photon Agronomy & Photon Throughput Economy on GitHub and Zenodo, presenting its framework, field experience and research hypotheses.

132 **30 Sep 2026** [redacted]

133 **30 SEP 2026** [redacted]

134 **30 Sep 2026** [redacted]

135 **7 Oct 2026 FTC-USDA equipment inquiry**
The agencies invite public comments on agricultural equipment manufacturing, distribution, market access and competition.

136 **13 Oct 2026 U.S. permanent injunction signed**
Docket 105 signed October 13; filing and separate judgment entry follow October 14.

162 **13 Oct 2026** [redacted]

163 **14 Oct 2026 U.S. judgment entered**
The permanent-injunction order is filed as Docket 105, and the separate civil judgment is entered as Docket 106.

137 **16 OCT 2026** [redacted]

164 **19 Oct 2026 Carbon workforce cuts reported**
GeekWire reports company-confirmed workforce reductions at Carbon Robotics.

165 **21 Oct 2026** [redacted]

166 **26 Oct 2026** [redacted]

Sources for selected public events

#59 | Hybrid Dual Licensing V1.0

May 3, 2025 public release post. Christopher Laudando clarifies that the GitHub perception release was part of Dual Licensing V1.0; Alpha Module perception came years earlier.

https://www.linkedin.com/posts/laudando_github-laudando-associates-llclaser-a-activity-7324580567704883200-Gf93

#62, #85 and #100 | Speech and Australian deployments

Christopher Laudando provides the firsthand account of speaking at AgTech Alchemy and deploying the Row Ready L&Aser implement at Busch Organics and Peninsula Fresh Organics. The event confirmation supplies the May 19, 2025 date and Seattle venue; the preprint describes the Australian field periods.

#93 | RFK Jr. and Theo Von

This Past Weekend #639, published February 12, 2026; laser-weeding discussion around 15:14-17:07. Carbon Robotics also links the coverage from its own news page.

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=yp8z-IaUmD0&t=914s

https://carbonrobotics.com/news

#97 and #119 | Deere cycle-bottom forecast

Deere earnings releases dated February 19 and August 20, 2026.

https://www.deere.com/assets/pdfs/common/news/deere-1q26-earnings-release.pdf

https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/deere-reports-third-quarter-net-income-of-1-379-billion-302856316.html

#107 | Monsanto v. Durnell

Supreme Court opinion, No. 24-1068, June 25, 2026.

https://www.supremecourt.gov/opinions/25pdf/24-1068_n7ip.pdf

#115 | ARPA-H STREAM

Program scope includes precision and nonchemical weed control.

https://arpa-h.gov/explore-funding/programs/stream

#131 | Photon Agronomy public release

GitHub published the release on September 29, 2026 at 13:45:35 UTC. Zenodo records the same publication date and creation at 13:58:30 UTC. September 28 is the manuscript date.

https://zenodo.org/records/23038733

https://github.com/Laudando-Associates-LLC/LASER/releases/tag/photon-agronomy-v19-rev1